



JAMAICA CONSTABULARY FORCE
National Police College of Jamaica Department of Weapons and Tactical Training Fighting
in Built-up Areas Policy and SOP

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Department of Weapons and Tactical Training

Fighting in Built-Up Areas Policy and Standard Operating Procedures

1.0 Introduction

The first priority of the Training Village is to meet specific training objectives, but safety must be at the forefront of the training exercise. The FIBUA Policy sets out regulations regarding the staffing, management and operation of the Fighting In Built Up Area (FIBUA) Village. The policy is supported by Standard Operational Procedures which must be adhered to by FIBUA staff and participants involved in training exercise as well as persons observing the training.

2.0 Purpose

The purpose of this document is to operationally expose members of the JCF to the various tactical maneuvers to prepare them to operate in densely populated inner city communities. The village is design to reflect the outlay of the geographical design of these communities and the dangers they may be exposed to whilst policing these areas.

3.0 Scope

The procedures in this document applies to members of the Jamaica Constabulary force, Jamaica Defense Force, Jamaica Customs, and any other personnel who may from time to time utilize the Fighting In Built Up Area (FIBUA) Tactical Village.

4.0 Abbreviations and Acronyms

FIBUA - Fighting In Built Up Area

VITCO - Village Training Conducting Officer

C-TOC - Counter Terrorism and Organized Crime

VSO - Village Safety Officers

VTO - Village Training Officers

FAO - First Aid Officer(s)

NSP - Normal Safety Precaution

AD - Ammunition Detail

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BFA - Blank Firing Attachment

5.0 Definitions

6.0 Responsibilities

Personnel and Duties

6.1 Village Training Conducting Officer (VITCO)

The VITCO is the person who has overall responsibility for all training exercises that is conducted at the FIBUA Village. The VITCO must be trained and certified for his role and must not be below the rank of Sergeant.

It is the responsibility of the VITCO for detailing, briefing and putting in place the necessary training staff. The VITCO and his staff must remain in charge of the exercise from the commencement to the completion.

They must ensure that the training is delivered according to plan and ensure that all personnel comply with the safety regulations and procedures prescribed for the conduct of the Training Village Exercises.

For each training exercise, the VITCO must detail and be in command of the following staff:

- Village Safety Officers (VSOs)
- Village Training Officers (VTOs)
- Ammunition Detail
- Range Warden(s)
- First Aid Officer(s) (FAO)
- Armed Guards.

6.2 Village Safety Officers (VSOs)

The VSOs, who plays the role of compliance officers, are responsible to the VITCO to ensure that course participants and trainers who utilize the training village follow all safety regulations in order to prevent the potential for personal injury and property damage.

The VSOs have the responsibilities to take immediate action when circumstances require it. The VSOs are the village's officials who constantly observe participants and trainers throughout the exercise to ensure safety and to help the trainers and trainees. There should be one VSO to every *detail* involved in an exercise.

6.3 Village Training Officers (VTOs)

VTOs are highly trained and certified officers who conduct tactical training in the FIBUA Village. They will be responsible for directing the actual training of the participants. They will be under the direct supervision of the VITCO.

6.4 Ammunition Detail

This detail is composed of one or more ammunition handlers whose responsibilities are to break down, issue, receive, account for and safeguard ammunition. The detail also collects expended ammunition casings and other residue. **The ammunition detail should also** issue magazines, Blank Firing Attachment (BFAs) and any special devices to be used for the exercise.

6.5 Range Warden(s)

A Range Warden is responsible for preparing the Village by putting in place necessary target mechanism and relevant signals and warning signs prior to the commencement of the training exercise.

6.6 First Aid Officer(s) (FAO)

An FAO is responsible for the custody and maintenance of first aid equipment, supplies, communication devices and a vehicle. These are necessary for the FAO to render first aid if the need arises and manage the safe conveyance of casualties in the event of an accident.

6.7 Armed Guards

Adequate armed uniformed guards must be deployed at the FIBUA Village for the protection of the participants and training staff. They must wear high visibility vests with labels and **MUST** not enter the FIBUA Village. They must be strategically placed on the perimeter of the village.

7.0 RISK MANAGEMENT

The VITCO must conduct an early Risk Assessment for all training exercises and may be guided in the process as follows:

- Risk Management Process
- *Identify the Hazards*

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- *Assess the Hazards*
- *Make a Risk Decision*
- *Implement Controls*
- *Supervise*

7.1 Risk Management Process

The process of risk management is a complete cycle that feeds back to its starting point in a logical manner. A key consideration in managing risk is to match the process to the extent of the risk probability. Generally, all steps of the process should be retained with curtailment achieved by cutting back on the details of each step, not by eliminating a step. Steps will be documented on a risk management worksheet and a daily risk assessment checklist.

7.2 Identify the Hazards

The hazards are the potential sources of danger that could be encountered while performing a task or mission. Leaders must try to identify all hazards associated with the operation or training. Special attention should be paid to identifying those hazards that have the potential to change such as weather, level of supervision, trainer/trainee alertness, terrain, equipment conditions, and so on. In this situation, each possibility should be identified; for example, weather changes could include heat, cold, lightning, high wind, rain etc.

7.3 Assess the Hazards

Identified hazards must be assessed to determine their cumulative effect on the operation. Controls will be developed for each identified hazard to reduce or eliminate the risk. The risk level for each hazard and the overall operation will be determined before implementation of control measures (initial) and after controls are implemented (residual).

7.4 Make a Risk Decision

Weigh the risk against the benefits of conducting training or performing an operation. Initial risk levels, controls, and residual risk levels should be considered when making a risk acceptance decision. Risk decisions must be made at a level that corresponds with the degree of risk.

7.5 Implement Controls

The controls established as a result of the first three steps are implemented in step four, including leader action to reduce or eliminate hazards. Specific controls will be integrated into plans, orders, SOPs, training performance standards, and rehearsals. Knowledge of controls down to the individual soldier or employee is essential.

7.6 Supervise

Supervision goes beyond ensuring that personnel do what is expected of them. It includes following up during and after an action to ensure that all went according to plan, re-evaluating the plan or making adjustments as required to accommodate unforeseen issues, and incorporating lessons learned for future use.

8.0 Policy Statement

9.0 Standard Operating Procedures

These guidelines must be administered by the Village Management Team and strictly adhered to by Trainers and participants in training exercises at the FIBUA Village:

- 9.1 All Training of police officers at the Fighting in Built Up Areas (FIBUA) Village must be conducted by the Department of Weapons and Tactical Training (DWTT). All such training shall be conducted under the direction and supervision of the Village Training Conducting Officer (VITCO) and his staff.
- 9.2 Prior to conducting a training exercise, a written application must be submitted to the Officer in charge of Operations and Skills Training followed by the preparation of an operation order by DWTT. Said Officer should ensure that the request is vetted by the VITCO before giving approval. All application should be submitted at least two weeks before the commencement of the training exercise. Full details of the training objectives, their exercise/scenario and the various maneuverings, duration, profile and number of participants, etc must be outlined in the OPS Order.
- 9.3 On arrival of participants, a Muster parade and briefing must be conducted by the VITCO, clearly outlining the safety precautions that must be adhered to whilst operating in the F.I.B.UA training village. A Normal Safety Precaution (NSP) must be done by the VSOs, inspecting weapons and magazines.
- 9.4 Course participants must be given an orientation of the Village by the **VTO** before being briefed for the exercise.
- 9.5 A declaration must be made to the VTCO by each participant and instructor alike stating that he/she has no live ammunition whatsoever on his/her person prior to the commencement of the exercise. This declaration will be made on a prescribe form and signed by all parties making such declaration. The forms will be retained by the VITCO. A mandatory physical

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search must be carried out on each participant and instructor taking part in the training exercise by the VSO.

- 9.6 The Ammunition Detail (AD) will issue blank ammunition and magazines immediately before the scheduled training exercises. Detailed record must be kept of the quantity and caliber of blank ammunition issues to each participant/instructor. The ammunition detail should also issue magazines, BFAs and any special devices to be used for the exercise.
- 9.7 All live ammunition regardless of caliber must be taken from participants and instructors involved in the training exercise by the VSO before entering the FIBUA Village and properly recorded and stored in the designated area.
- 9.8 Blank Firing Attachment (BFA) must be affixed to all weapons used where applicable, by the participants under the tutelage and supervision of the VSO.
- 9.9 The muzzle of the weapons must not be pointed directly at anyone when operating weapon with blank rounds.
- 9.10 Where assimilation exercise involves engagement between the police and a group threat force, the police must be properly dressed in uniform or fatigue gears and the treat force must be dressed in civil clothing. The FIBUA staff and observer (where such persons are present) must wear high visibility vests.
- 9.11 At the conclusion of the exercise the AD must collect and record all ammunition and other devices returned by each participant/trainer taking note of their condition.
- 9.12 The training staff must engage the participants to retrieve all expended casings and hand them over to the AD.
- 9.13 A debriefing and declaration must be conducted after every training exercise.
- 9.14 Once the command cease fire is given all firing must stop immediately.
- 9.15 The Ammunition Detail should ensure that blank rounds and live rounds are not transported in the same vehicle.
- 9.16 Where a member breaches the standing by taking live ammo in the village, such member shall be disqualified and reported on for disciplinary action. The live ammo must be confiscated by the VSO, properly packaged and labeled and handed at the designated area.
- 9.17 Where participants are engaged in continuous training on moving from live fire practice on the range to the FIBUA Village, there should be a minimum of one (1) hour break between each session. This break does not include time used for briefing/debriefing, NSP and declaration.